

THE NOHO RAG: EPISODE 202
OFF TO THE RACES

Written by

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INT. WRITER'S ROOM

Bob flips through binders. Shifts boxes from cubby hole to cubby hole. Paces. Scratches his head. Then looks over to the desk on the other side of the room.

Sitting lifelessly, OLIVIA stares blankly at Bob.

OLIVIA
Is it five yet?

BOB
We have new anchors now!
(beat)
They will read what you write!
(beat)
They need what you write.
(beat)
They need **you**, Olivia.

OLIVIA
For once!
(beat)
You know how many segments I got on
the air with Alec?

Bob looks with a smirk to the ceiling.

BOB
I was a fan of your game boy
retrospective.

OLIVIA
One!

Bob keeps looking off to the ceiling.

BOB
(sotto)
It really was the best system.

OLIVIA
One, Bob!
(beat)
In almost two years!

Bob looks somberly back at Olivia.

BOB
Well you got your wish. Alec is
gone.
(beat)
But Alec.
(beat)
(MORE)

BOB (CONT'D)
 ... Kinda did all our jobs...
 (beat)
 So now, it's time to do the jobs we
 were hired for.
 (beat)
 You know...
 (beat)
 The jobs we're getting paid for?

OLIVIA
 So...
 (beat)
 Does this mean we can cover the
 stories we want now?

BOB
 Uhh...
 (beat)
 Sure.

Bob and Olivia nod. Olivia turns back to her desk.

BOB (CONT'D)
 Just no nudity.
 (beat)
 Deal?

Olivia doesn't hear Bob. She obsessively stares at her
 computer screen.

OLIVIA
 At last.
 (beat)
 My reign begins!

SMASH TO: TITLE CARD

INT. NEWS DESK

Dane and Kelly Mae do what they came here to do. News time:

DANE
 Good evening.
 (beat)
 I.
 (beat)
 Am Dane Argyle.

KELLY MAE
 And I'm Kelly Mae Greenblat.
 (beat)
 Tonight.
 (MORE)

KELLY MAE (CONT'D)
NoHo civilians headed out to the
polls to replace Wilson DiNapoli,
the NoHo Comptroller.

(beat)

Whom you may recall two weeks ago
gave an expletive laden surprise
resignation speech.

(beat)

The two candidates receiving the
most votes will now face off in the
general election later this year.

DANE

You mean we'll have to vote again?!

KELLY MAE

Yes, Dane. It said that on the
ballot.

DANE

(sotto)

But that church smelled weird!

Dane throws his arms up and looks annoyed.

KELLY MAE

We now go live to the first
winner's campaign headquarters.
Where Eugene Knotts, that little
sweetheart, is preparing to take
the stage.

CUT TO:

INT. CAMPAIGN HEADQUARTERS - ON GREEN

EUGENE KNOTTS is half Don Knotts and half Mr. Rogers. He
stands in suit and tie and attempts to hush cheers.

He begins to remove his suit jacket and reveals a cardigan.

EUGENE

Hello, there!

(beat)

Thank you!

(beat)

Thanks everybody!

Eugene reaches off camera for a warm glass of milk.

He pulls one hand away quickly and shakes it.

EUGENE (CONT'D)

Ooh!

(beat)

Warm!

Eugene addresses the crowd.

EUGENE (CONT'D)

Well, folks!

(beat)

I'm just so happy we did it!

(beat)

We're gonna keep on pushing.

(beat)

And we're gonna win that little old election later this year...

(beat)

And we're gonna clean up our town!

Audience erupts!

EUGENE (CONT'D)

Thank you, guys!

Eugene yawns endearingly.

EUGENE (CONT'D)

Ok, off to bed...

Eugene turns and walks off.

INT. NOHO STUDIOS - NEWS DESK

Two shot.

DANE

Adorable.

(beat)

And now we go to the headquarters of the other big winner of the evening, Blake Pearson.

(beat)

Notable for spending a record amount on his runoff campaign.

INT. CAMPAIGN HEADQUARTERS - GREEN SCREEN

Campaign headquarters is lively. Like a rave. Blake Pearson takes the stage.

BLAKE

Whoo!

(beat)

Alright NoHo!

The audience calms.

BLAKE (CONT'D)

Everybody got your complimentary
vitamin water?

(beat)

Well, raise them high!

(beat)

For today we are victors!

(beat)

And in the upcoming general
election, we will be champions!

(beat)

And to really help kick off our big
campaign, we welcome our new
corporate partner:

A sign squeaks slowly down from the fly space. It shows the
logo of:

BLAKE (CONT'D)

The craft beer division of the
Cahuenga Valley Brewing Company,
LLC

Cheers.

BLAKE (CONT'D)

Now let's launch this big campaign
the best way THIS CANDIDATE know
how:

(beat)

With victory tote bags, graciously
provided by Fossil.

Blake's voice snaps to a standard Ad Announcer voice:

BLAKE (CONT'D)

For when you first get a day job.

(beat)

Fossil.

INT. NOHO STUDIOS - NEWS DESK

Two shot.

Dane looks at his watch.

DANE

Hmm...

(beat)

Kelly Mae, what exactly is a run off election?

Kelly Mae turns, almost excited at Dane's banter ability.

KELLY MAE

Well!

(beat)

It's a preliminary election where the two candidates who get the most votes then move on to the general election.

(beat)

So, we'll be seeing a lot more of those two.

DANE

Ah interesting.

(beat)

Well, run off means something a little different.

(beat)

To me.

KELLY MAE

Okay.

DANE

And there's nothing preliminary about it!

KELLY MAE

Dane.

DANE

It just happens.

KELLY MAE

Okay well, from everyone here at NoHo

DANE

Mostly after a spicy meal.

KELLY MAE

I'm Kelly Mae-

DANE

(sotto)

It **always** burns.

KELLY MAE
Greenblatt.

DANE
And I'm Dane Argyle.
(beat)
Good luck. And good evening.

CUT TO:

REVERSE ANGLE OF NEWS DESK

Bob does his standard sigh of relief even though it kind of ended rocky.

Dane walks past.

DANE
Good show everybody.
(beat)
Take note.
(beat)
That's how you tell the news.

Bob stops Dane at the end of his sentence.

BOB
Dane.

DANE
Yeah, Bob.

BOB
I need to talk to you about how you tell the news.

DANE
Great!

BOB
Dane.

DANE
Notes.

BOB
You have to-

DANE
Love it.

BOB
If you would just-

DANE
Love it, Bob!

BOB
Yeah, great.
(beat)
Please avoid colorful references to
bowel movements during the sign
off.
(beat)
Like I've told you...

DANE
Right right.
(beat)
Well, sometimes it just spills out
of me.

BOB
Yeah like that.
(beat)
No more.

DANE
Ten-Four.

Dane walks off.

Bob shakes his head.

EXT. ALLEY BEHIND STUDIO

Kelly Mae walks to her car and begins loading it. Dane
follows shortly there after and saddles up behind her.

DANE
Great job in there.

Dane makes a check in the air.

DANE (CONT'D)
Public: Informed

Kelly Mae spins and faces Dane.

KELLY MAE
Yeah. Informed about your regularly
unpleasant digestive issues.

DANE
Hey. Bob says adlib, I talk about
what I know.

KELLY MAE
 Well, learn something else.
 (beat)
 Scrapbooking.
 (beat)
 Macramae!
 (beat)
 Sports!
 (beat)
 Something! Anything!
 (beat)
 Just not poop.

DANE
 Hmm, they loved it back in Des
 Moines.

Kelly Mae does a whole body sigh and drops her head into her hand.

KELLY MAE
 Look Dane, you brought us all the
 way out here.

DANE
 Big Hollywood News.

KELLY MAE
North Hollywood. Not Hollywood.
 Which I'm now learning are two
 strikingly different places.

DANE
 Still a step up from Des Moines.

KELLY MAE
 I was perfectly happy there.

Kelly points at Dane and presses her index finger into his chest.

KELLY MAE (CONT'D)
You, if you recall, gave a drunken
 and damned convincing call to
 arms...

Dane looks off to the horizon proudly.

KELLY MAE (CONT'D)
 Made me agree to uproot my life in
 Des Moines.

Dane scoffs.

DANE
Life in Des Moines?
(beat)
There wasn't much life to uproot.
(beat)
Look, Leon left you two years ago.
(beat)
Since then, how often have you
broken off plans after work for a
night of white wine and xanax?

Dane grabs Kelly Mae's arms.

DANE (CONT'D)
And we're here!

Dane swings to Kelly Mae's side throws one arm over her
shoulder and reaches out his free hand to the horizon.

DANE (CONT'D)
One step closer.
(beat)
To Big.
(beat)
Hollywood.
(beat)
News.

Kelly Mae concedes.

KELLY MAE
Well, it **is** warmer here than Iowa.
(beat)
And there **is** a damn good pie shop
two blocks from my apartment.

DANE
Is this an invitation?

KELLY MAE
I just gotta stop home and let the
dog out.

DANE
Oh, I love the BAJA Men.

Fade to black.